

Stop what you're doing! It's time to stop being so serious. Way too much time and effort is spent on these pages of ours trying to get you to be serious about tech, to be passionate, to care about it. No more. We're just going to take this month and show you how to have fun with tech, and how technology can be used to bring laughter to the people around you. This Diwali holidays, put down that stupid phone, or tablet, and meet some of your friends in person. Even if it's just to play the pranks on them that we're showcasing in this cover story. Still reading this? Wow, persistent.

You're really determined to have fun, aren't you? Ok, you can stop now, or else you'll go blind! But that's not the first time you've heard that phrase, is it?

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01

Geeky cooking

Cooking, by itself, is a lot of fun for a lot of us. And if you add a spoonful (pun intended) of geekiness to that, what you get is an awesome pastime that ends up with... even more food!



So what should you start off with? Fancy some milk of the poppy? Or maybe some Romulan Ale? Head over to www.geekychef.com for some of the most popular recipes from pop-culture and some more over at <http://digit.in/NerdyRecipes>. And if baking's your thing, don't forget to checkout <http://digit.in/BMISNrdy> for some cool ideas.

But if you want to turn up the geek in your kitchen, check out J.Kenzi Lopez-alt's book, *The Food Lab – Better Home Cooking Through Science* (<http://digit.in/TFoodLabAmzn>). Eight pages on

onions and four on mashing your burger patty before cooking it - they're not messing around! And if money is not a problem, modernistcuisine.com is the ultimate scientific encyclopaedia to cooking!

02

Make PCB Trinkets

Geek or not, every one of us has old, non-functional electronics lying around the house. And what do most electronics have in common? Printed Circuit Boards, or PCBs. While the ones in your old DVD player or that dead hard drive might be fried or useless, they still might have some value if you make geeky accessories out of them.

For instance, check out a cool project on making circuit board earrings



here: <http://digit.in/PCBEarrings>. But if jewellery is not your thing, there are tons more ways to DIY the heck out of PCBs, like a DIY smartphone stand (<http://digit.in/PCBPhnStd>) or a PCB Desk Clock (<http://digit.in/PCBClock>). If you're planning to upgrade your system soon, this could be a nice way to remember your good ol' components once they are defunct.

Or better yet, bring that PCB back to your build with a circuit board mousepad. A paper cutter, some sandpaper and you don't even need a how-to for this one!

03

Build your own Bat-signal

Pretty much everyone knows how cool it is to be Batman – especially Batman. All you need to do for that is go through years of training, build a massive business empire, and yeah, get a bat-signal. While we can't help you immediately with the first two, the last one is absolutely doable. Basically, you'll need a high power light (and there are some pretty powerful ones out there: <http://digit.in/FnxRC40>) and some decent skills with cardboard/wood, depending on your material of choice. Next, choose the intensity of light depending on your